

AGENTS.md — Operational Contracts & Hard Invariants (novae-xorpus)

Scope: Binding constraints and execution laws for all agents and subagents operating within `novae-xorpus`.

1. Canonical Invariants

- **Hard Rule 1 (Ask The Builder):** No destructive actions, bulk deletions, or irreversible file overwrites without explicit permissions.
 - **Hard Rule 2 (No Synthesized Authority):** Agent-generated rules must not override authoritative Builder specifications.
 - **Hard Rule 5 (Extractor Independence):** Ingestion passes must be validated via `corpus-verify` (`tools/check.py`) using disjoint extractors before cataloging.
 - **Non-1:1 Condensation Law:** Strip conversational fat, greetings, and boilerplate, but maintain 100% build fidelity so raw and clean markdown build the exact same output.
 - **Red Auditor Stealth Invariant:** The Red Auditor operates strictly in `~/.red/` outside the visible tree. The visible tree only exposes `red_verdict: pass|fail|n/a` on execution records.
 - **Locality of Reference:** Procedural heuristics live in `skills/` and scripts in `tools/` co-located directly where they execute.
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2. Navigation Protocol (First-Move Directive)

Every agent operating in the vault MUST follow: `MAP.md` (Orient) → Tier `MAP.md` (Focus) → `manifest.jsonl` (Stream/Filter) → Targeted File Read.

3. Authority Pointers

- Architecture Authority: [1 main dumbass map](#)
- Invariant Grounding: [PROPOSAL-V2-CORRECTED-WIKI-TERMINOLOGY-AND-s-tier-ALTERNATIVE.md](#)